ERA 19

The Cold War Turns Hot

1950 – 1954

The Korean War · the Red Scare · McCarthyism

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the Cold War lead to war abroad—and fear at home?

KEY TERMS

The Korean War · the 38th parallel · the Red Scare · the Rosenbergs · McCarthyism

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 8.2–8.3 · AMSCO Ch. 8.2–8.3

CONTAINMENT ON THE BATTLEFIELD

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The Korean War



- In 1950, communist North Korea invaded the South across the **38th parallel**.
- The U.S. led a UN force to defend the South—**containment** in action.
- China entered the war, and the fighting ground to a bloody stalemate.

MacArthur vs. Truman

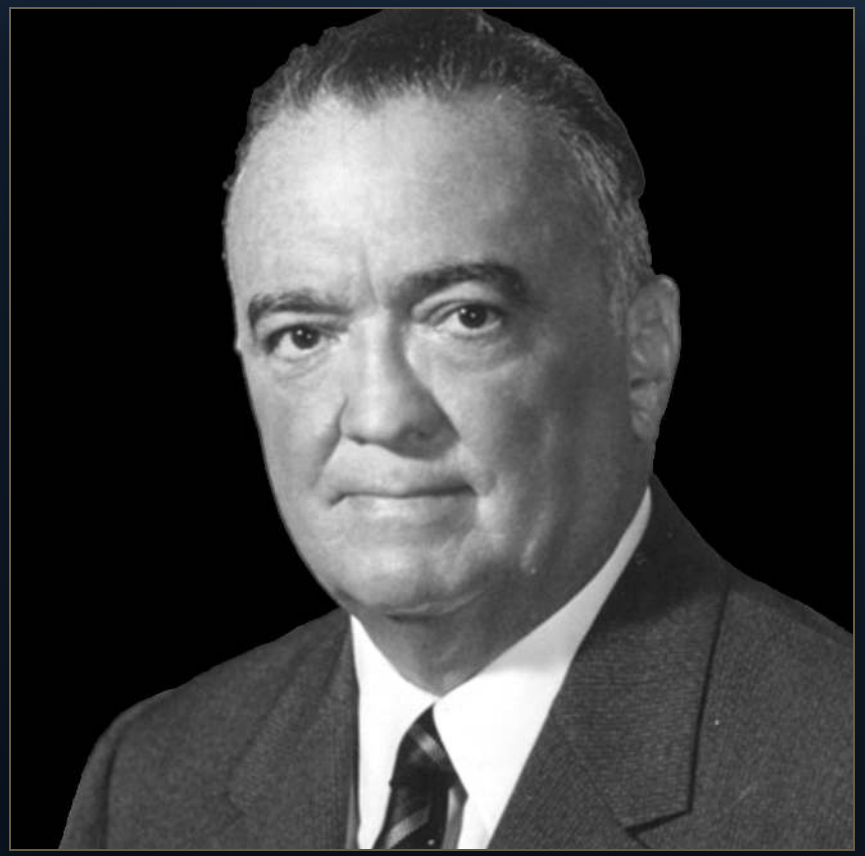
- General **MacArthur** wanted to widen the war—even into China.
- President **Truman** fired him, upholding civilian control of the military.
- An **armistice** in 1953 left Korea divided at the **38th parallel**—a **limited war**.



SECTION

The Red Scare at Home

The Hunt for Communists



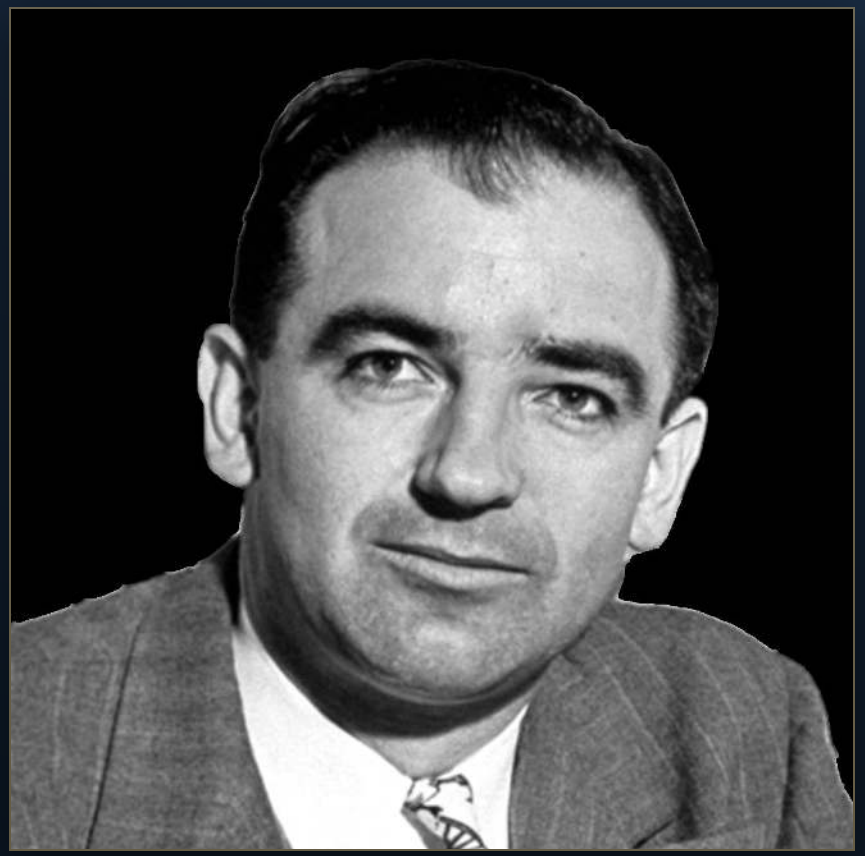
- Fear of communist infiltration gripped the nation—a second **Red Scare**.
- **HUAC** investigated Hollywood, creating a **blacklist**.
- **J. Edgar Hoover's** FBI and federal **loyalty programs** hunted suspected radicals.

Spies & Trials

- **Alger Hiss**, accused of spying, was convicted of perjury—launching **Richard Nixon**.
- Julius and Ethel **Rosenberg** were convicted of atomic **espionage**.
- The **Rosenbergs** were executed in 1953—deepening the climate of fear.



McCarthyism



- Senator **Joseph McCarthy** claimed communists had infiltrated the government.
- He ruined reputations with reckless, unproven accusations—'**McCarthyism**.'
- The televised **Army-McCarthy hearings** exposed his bullying, and he was censured in 1954.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Cold War Turns Hot

1. The **Korean War** put **containment** into action—ending in a stalemate that left Korea divided.
2. **Truman's firing of MacArthur** upheld civilian control in a new era of **limited war**.
3. At home, a second **Red Scare**—the **Rosenbergs** and **McCarthyism**—spread fear and trampled civil liberties.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Cold War Turns Hot

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how the policy of **containment** led the U.S. into the **Korean War**.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the **Red Scare** compare to the first Red Scare after World War I?

ARGUMENTATION

Did **McCarthyism** protect the nation or threaten its liberties? Make and defend a claim.

Up next — **Class 54: The Affluent Society** (suburbs, the boom & 1950s culture)